

Mermaid Pre-render Workaround

Template Author

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About this template

Pandoc has no first-class Mermaid support. Two strategies exist:

1. **raghur/mermaid-filter** — works for HTML and standalone LaTeX PDFs but fails inside beamer frames (fragile frame + `\includegraphics` interaction).
2. **Pre-render** (this template) — run `mmdc` once to produce a `.png` and embed it as a normal image. Format-agnostic, beamer-safe, CI-friendly.

The pre-render workflow is the recommended default (Phase-0 gap G-MF-02).

Architecture diagram

The flow below is pre-rendered from `diagram.mmd` to `diagram.png`:

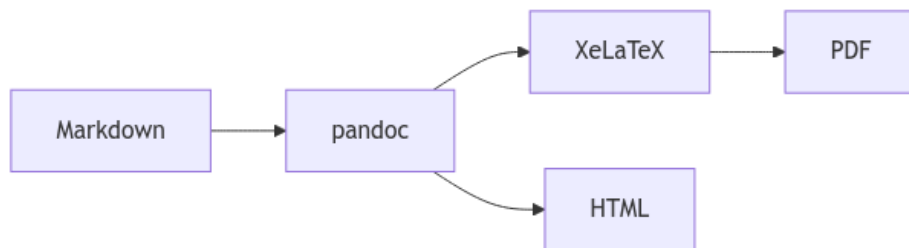


Figure 1: Pre-rendered Mermaid diagram

Pre-render one-liner

The companion Mermaid source (`diagram.mmd`) must be rendered before `pandoc` runs. One-liner (uncomment and run once per edit):

```
# mmdc -i diagram.mmd -o diagram.png -b white
```

Notes

- `mmdc` is the `@mermaid-js/mermaid-cli` binary; install via `npm i -g @mermaid-js/mermaid-cli` if missing.
- `-b white` forces a white background so the PNG prints cleanly.

- For HTML-only targets, the `mermaid-filter` alternative is documented in `references/diagrams-and-filters` (added in Phase 2).
- Beamer users: stick with `pre-render`; `mermaid-filter` regularly breaks fragile frames.

Compile

```
# 1) render the diagram once
```

```
mmdc -i diagram.mmd -o diagram.png -b white
```

```
# 2) compile the PDF
```

```
pandoc mermaid-workaround.md \  
  --pdf-engine=xelatex \  
  -o mermaid-workaround.pdf
```